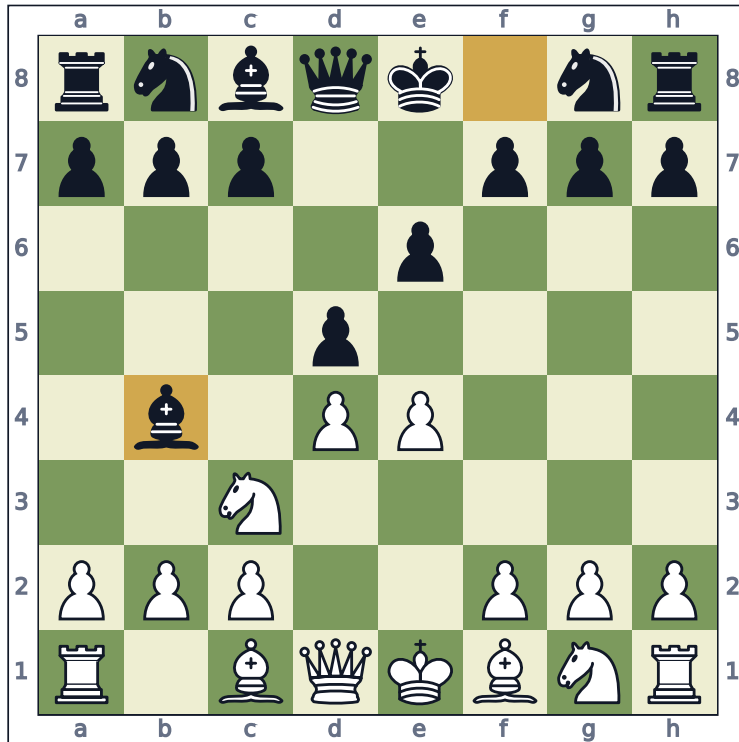


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C15 | 14 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.90 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C15 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Winawer Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C15 line

This section preserves all 14 names and defining routes assigned to C15 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: McCutcheon Variation, Wolf Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Ne2 Nf6 5. Bg5

002 French Defense: Winawer Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4

003 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Alekhine Gambit Accepted

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Ne2 dxe4 5. a3 Bxc3+

004 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Alekhine Gambit, Alatortsev Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Ne2 dxe4 5. a3 Be7 6. Nxe4 Nf6 7. N2g3 O-O 8. Be2 Nc6

005 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Alekhine Gambit, Kan Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Ne2 dxe4 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. Nxc3 Nc6

006 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Alekhine-Maróczy Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Ne2

007 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Delayed Exchange Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. exd5

008 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Exchange Variation, Canal Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. Qh5

009 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Fingerslip Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bd2

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C15 line

This section preserves all 14 names and defining routes assigned to C15 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Fingerslip Variation, Kunin Double Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bd2 dxe4 5. Qg4 Qxd4

011 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Fingerslip Variation, Main Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bd2 dxe4 5. Qg4 Nf6 6. Qxg7 Rg8 7. Qh6

012 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Fingerslip Variation, Schwarz's Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bd2 Ne7 5. Nb1

013 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Kondratiyev Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bd3 c5 5. exd5 Qxd5 6. Bd2

014 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Winckelmann-Reimer Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. a3 Bxc3+ 5. bxc3 dxe4 6. f3